

Medical Devices English Dialogue Lab

Realistic field-specific dialogues, role-play variations, and observer checklists

Audience: medical device engineers, product managers, quality and regulatory staff, clinical specialists, manufacturing teams, field-service teams, and device-company leaders

Focus: A device-focused professional English curriculum for design controls, risk management, usability, verification and validation, regulatory pathways, complaint handling, quality systems, manufacturing, and clinical-user dialogue.

Designed for advanced ESL learners who already use professional English and need industry-specific terminology, realistic meetings, role-play pressure, careful pushback, and polished workplace outputs.

Teaching stance: this is language and workplace-communication training, not legal, medical, financial, safety, or regulatory advice. Instructors should connect every scenario to the learner's current company policies, local rules, and approved procedures.

Dialogue Practice Method

Read each exchange once for meaning, once for tone, and once for decision structure. Then complete the missing language by selecting one of four options and check the rationale at the end.

1. User Needs and Design Inputs

Setting

A surgeon requests a feature after a product demo.

Speaker	Line
Product manager	Add it to the roadmap as requested.
Design engineer	User need, design input, intended use, and risk must be separated.
ESL learner	I understand the goal, but we need to separate urgency from control. For this decision, I need to confirm user need, design input, the owner, and the evidence standard before we commit.
Product manager	What would let us move forward without slowing everything down?
ESL learner	Let's document the assumption, define the risk trigger, and create a short design-input clarification. Then we can decide whether to proceed, escalate, or revise the plan.

Language notes

- The learner names the field-specific control point instead of giving a vague no: user need, design input.
- The response preserves the business goal while adding evidence, owner, and next-step discipline.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects design input.

Option	Phrase
A	operating constraint
B	decision owner
C	design input
D	user need

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Add it to the roadmap as requested.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	I understand the urgency. I need to verify user need and design input against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
B	evidence threshold
C	approval path
D	operating constraint

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A surgeon requests a feature after a product demo. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	operating constraint
C	decision owner
D	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the design-input clarification with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.

Observer checklist

- Did the learner name the decision and the risk?
- Did the learner use at least two industry terms accurately?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step without overpromising?

2. Risk Management and Hazard Analysis

Setting

A team calls a rare use error acceptable.

Speaker	Line
Quality engineer	Document that the risk is low and move on.
R&D lead	Severity, probability, detectability, and mitigation evidence need review.
ESL learner	I understand the goal, but we need to separate urgency from control. For this decision, I need to confirm hazard, harm, the owner, and the evidence standard before we commit.
Quality engineer	What would let us move forward without slowing everything down?
ESL learner	Let's document the assumption, define the risk trigger, and create a short risk-control rationale. Then we can decide whether to proceed, escalate, or revise the plan.

Language notes

- The learner names the field-specific control point instead of giving a vague no: hazard, harm.
- The response preserves the business goal while adding evidence, owner, and next-step discipline.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects harm.

Option	Phrase
A	decision owner
B	harm
C	FMEA

Option	Phrase
D	hazard

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Document that the risk is low and move on.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	I understand the urgency. I need to verify hazard and harm against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
B	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.
C	evidence threshold
D	approval path

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A team calls a rare use error acceptable. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the risk-control rationale with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
B	approval path
C	operating constraint
D	decision owner

Observer checklist

- Did the learner name the decision and the risk?
- Did the learner use at least two industry terms accurately?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step without overpromising?

3. Verification, Validation, and Design Review

Setting

Leadership asks whether testing is finished.

Speaker	Line
Regulatory lead	Say yes because verification passed.
Engineering manager	Validation, usability, clinical workflow, and traceability may still be open.
ESL learner	I understand the goal, but we need to separate urgency from control. For this decision, I need to confirm verification, validation, the owner, and the evidence standard before we commit.
Regulatory lead	What would let us move forward without slowing everything down?
ESL learner	Let's document the assumption, define the risk trigger, and create a short V&V readiness update. Then we can decide whether to proceed, escalate, or revise the plan.

Language notes

- The learner names the field-specific control point instead of giving a vague no: verification, validation.
- The response preserves the business goal while adding evidence, owner, and next-step discipline.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects validation.

Option	Phrase
A	verification
B	approval path
C	operating constraint
D	decision owner

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Say yes because verification passed.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	approval path
C	operating constraint
D	I understand the urgency. I need to verify verification and validation against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - Leadership asks whether testing is finished. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the V&V readiness update with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
B	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.
C	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.
D	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.

Observer checklist

- Did the learner name the decision and the risk?
- Did the learner use at least two industry terms accurately?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step without overpromising?

4. Usability and Human Factors

Setting

A nurse repeatedly selects the wrong mode during formative testing.

Speaker	Line
Human-factors lead	Call it a training problem.
Clinical specialist	Interface design, labeling, workflow, and risk controls need assessment.
ESL learner	I understand the goal, but we need to separate urgency from control. For this decision, I need to confirm human factors, use error, the owner, and the evidence standard before we commit.
Human-factors lead	What would let us move forward without slowing everything down?
ESL learner	Let's document the assumption, define the risk trigger, and create a short human-factors finding. Then we can decide whether to proceed, escalate, or revise the plan.

Language notes

- The learner names the field-specific control point instead of giving a vague no: human factors, use error.
- The response preserves the business goal while adding evidence, owner, and next-step discipline.

Three-step decision practice**1. Complete the field language**

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects use error.

Option	Phrase
A	operating constraint
B	human factors
C	evidence threshold
D	approval path

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Call it a training problem.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	operating constraint
B	decision owner
C	I understand the urgency. I need to verify human factors and use error against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
D	approval path

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A nurse repeatedly selects the wrong mode during formative testing. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the human-factors finding with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
C	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.
D	evidence threshold

Observer checklist

- Did the learner name the decision and the risk?
- Did the learner use at least two industry terms accurately?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step without overpromising?

5. Regulatory Pathways and Submissions

Setting

Sales wants to say clearance is guaranteed because predicates exist.

Speaker	Line
Regulatory affairs	Tell customers clearance is straightforward.
Sales director	Predicate comparison, indications, performance data, and agency review remain uncertain.
ESL learner	I understand the goal, but we need to separate urgency from control. For this decision, I need to confirm 510(k), De Novo, the owner, and the evidence standard before we commit.
Regulatory affairs	What would let us move forward without slowing everything down?
ESL learner	Let's document the assumption, define the risk trigger, and create a short regulatory pathway caveat. Then we can decide whether to proceed, escalate, or revise the plan.

Language notes

- The learner names the field-specific control point instead of giving a vague no: 510(k), De Novo.
- The response preserves the business goal while adding evidence, owner, and next-step discipline.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects De Novo.

Option	Phrase
A	predicate device
B	510(k)
C	De Novo
D	PMA

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Tell customers clearance is straightforward.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	decision owner
B	We should act now and resolve 510(k) after the result is visible.
C	I understand the urgency. I need to verify 510(k) and De Novo against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
D	operating constraint

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - Sales wants to say clearance is guaranteed because predicates exist. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.
B	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.
C	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the regulatory pathway caveat with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
D	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.

Observer checklist

- Did the learner name the decision and the risk?
- Did the learner use at least two industry terms accurately?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step without overpromising?

6. Complaints, MDRs, and Postmarket Signals

Setting

A field rep hears about a device malfunction during a case.

Speaker	Line
Field clinical specialist	Handle it informally with the hospital.
Complaint handler	Complaint intake, adverse-event assessment, and reporting timelines may apply.
ESL learner	I understand the goal, but we need to separate urgency from control. For this decision, I need to confirm complaint, MDR, the owner, and the evidence standard before we commit.
Field clinical specialist	What would let us move forward without slowing everything down?
ESL learner	Let's document the assumption, define the risk trigger, and create a short complaint intake summary. Then we can decide whether to proceed, escalate, or revise the plan.

Language notes

- The learner names the field-specific control point instead of giving a vague no: complaint, MDR.
- The response preserves the business goal while adding evidence, owner, and next-step discipline.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects MDR.

Option	Phrase
A	operating constraint
B	decision owner
C	MDR
D	complaint

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Handle it informally with the hospital.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	I understand the urgency. I need to verify complaint and MDR against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
B	decision owner
C	We should act now and resolve complaint after the result is visible.
D	A complaint intake summary is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A field rep hears about a device malfunction during a case. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	decision owner
B	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.
C	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.
D	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the complaint intake summary with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.

Observer checklist

- Did the learner name the decision and the risk?
- Did the learner use at least two industry terms accurately?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step without overpromising?

7. Manufacturing, Suppliers, and Nonconformance

Setting

A supplier change caused dimensional variation.

Speaker	Line
Supply-chain lead	Use the parts to avoid backorder.
Quality manager	Nonconformance, disposition, supplier CAPA, and process validation must be resolved.
ESL learner	I understand the goal, but we need to separate urgency from control. For this decision, I need to confirm nonconformance, supplier CAPA, the owner, and the evidence standard before we commit.
Supply-chain lead	What would let us move forward without slowing everything down?
ESL learner	Let's document the assumption, define the risk trigger, and create a short supplier quality update. Then we can decide whether to proceed, escalate, or revise the plan.

Language notes

- The learner names the field-specific control point instead of giving a vague no: nonconformance, supplier CAPA.
- The response preserves the business goal while adding evidence, owner, and next-step discipline.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects supplier CAPA.

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	operating constraint
C	nonconformance
D	evidence threshold

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Use the parts to avoid backorder.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	I understand the urgency. I need to verify nonconformance and supplier CAPA against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
B	operating constraint
C	decision owner
D	We should act now and resolve nonconformance after the result is visible.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A supplier change caused dimensional variation. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	approval path

Option	Phrase
C	operating constraint
D	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the supplier quality update with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.

Observer checklist

- Did the learner name the decision and the risk?
- Did the learner use at least two industry terms accurately?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step without overpromising?

8. Clinical Training and Labeling Boundaries

Setting

A key opinion leader asks about an off-label technique.

Speaker	Line
Clinical trainer	Demonstrate the technique to build enthusiasm.
Surgeon	Labeling, intended use, clinical evidence, and compliance boundaries control the response.
ESL learner	I understand the goal, but we need to separate urgency from control. For this decision, I need to confirm labeling, instructions for use, the owner, and the evidence standard before we commit.
Clinical trainer	What would let us move forward without slowing everything down?
ESL learner	Let's document the assumption, define the risk trigger, and create a short label-safe training response. Then we can decide whether to proceed, escalate, or revise the plan.

Language notes

- The learner names the field-specific control point instead of giving a vague no: labeling, instructions for use.
- The response preserves the business goal while adding evidence, owner, and next-step discipline.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects instructions for use.

Option	Phrase
A	off-label
B	clinical evidence
C	labeling
D	instructions for use

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Demonstrate the technique to build enthusiasm.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.
B	evidence threshold
C	approval path
D	I understand the urgency. I need to verify labeling and instructions for use against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A key opinion leader asks about an off-label technique. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.
B	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the label-safe training response with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
C	decision owner
D	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.

Observer checklist

- Did the learner name the decision and the risk?
- Did the learner use at least two industry terms accurately?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step without overpromising?

Answer Key and Rationale

Check each stage after completing the practice sequence. The rationale explains the decision skill the strongest response demonstrates.

User Needs and Design Inputs - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. user need	'user need' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

User Needs and Design Inputs - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. I understand the urgency. I need to verify user need and design input against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

User Needs and Design Inputs - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the design-input clarification with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Risk Management and Hazard Analysis - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. hazard	'hazard' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Risk Management and Hazard Analysis - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. I understand the urgency. I need to verify hazard and harm against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Risk Management and Hazard Analysis - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the risk-control rationale with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Verification, Validation, and Design Review - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. verification	'verification' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Verification, Validation, and Design Review - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. I understand the urgency. I need to verify verification and validation against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Verification, Validation, and Design Review - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the V&V readiness update with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Usability and Human Factors - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. human factors	'human factors' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Usability and Human Factors - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. I understand the urgency. I need to verify human factors and use error against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Usability and Human Factors - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the human-factors finding with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Regulatory Pathways and Submissions - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. 510(k)	'510(k)' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Regulatory Pathways and Submissions - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. I understand the urgency. I need to verify 510(k) and De Novo against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Regulatory Pathways and Submissions - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the regulatory pathway caveat with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Complaints, MDRs, and Postmarket Signals - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. complaint	'complaint' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Complaints, MDRs, and Postmarket Signals - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. I understand the urgency. I need to verify complaint and MDR against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Complaints, MDRs, and Postmarket Signals - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the complaint intake summary with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Manufacturing, Suppliers, and Nonconformance - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. nonconformance	'nonconformance' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Manufacturing, Suppliers, and Nonconformance - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. I understand the urgency. I need to verify nonconformance and supplier CAPA against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Manufacturing, Suppliers, and Nonconformance - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the supplier quality update with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Clinical Training and Labeling Boundaries - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. labeling	'labeling' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Clinical Training and Labeling Boundaries - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. I understand the urgency. I need to verify labeling and instructions for use against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Clinical Training and Labeling Boundaries - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the label-safe training response with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.